

Chapter 42-2

//

The matter of the real daughter actually didn't have much impact on Liang Shi.

On the contrary, when the real daughter returned, she could directly sever ties with the Liang family. At worst, she would just have to move out of this villa and leave the company.

Her life would continue as normal.

What made her mentally exhausted was the matter with Qi Taitai. She could ignore everything else, but this one thing alone—

Was too real.

Real to the point of suffocation.

It was just that there were no information leads whatsoever.

The rain outside was getting heavier, pattering incessantly. It looked like it wouldn't stop anytime soon, and might even continue through the night.

According to the housekeeper, every year after Haizhou City¹ entered autumn, it would rain for a very long time.

Coastal cities, once they started having continuous rain, would become damp, with moisture even in the air. In more severe cases, one could smell the thick fishy scent of the sea.

It was also dinnertime.

Liang Shi didn't feel like eating anything, but Xu Qingzhu still needed to eat.

She was thinking about the evening's menu in her room when there came a knock on the door—three very light taps. The sound of knuckles against wood carried a muffled quality that wouldn't make anyone feel annoyed.

"Liang Shi, time to eat." Xu Qingzhu said.

Her voice was clear and cold, but today when she spoke, she slowed down a bit, making her seem less aloof.

Liang Shi turned on the room light.

The sudden brightness was dazzling. She raised her hand to block the light, then got up to open the door.

Xu Qingzhu wore a light purple silk nightgown, her long hair covering her collarbone and the alluring curves of her chest.

This outfit made her skin appear even more fair. Combined with the dim lighting in the hallway, the only ventilated window was at the end of the corridor, where strong wind was battering the window frame, making rustling sounds.

Just standing there, Xu Qingzhu was like a light source in the dark night.

Ethereally independent, as if glowing in solitude.

Liang Shi stepped back half a step, not wanting her to discover her low spirits.

She was someone who didn't like exposing or burdening others with her bad emotions.

Shared happiness becomes double happiness, but shared sadness becomes double sadness.

So share more happiness and less sadness.

Liang Shi had always been this way.

She forced a smile, acting as if nothing was wrong, "Is dinner ready?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu said: "I ordered takeout."

"I slept all afternoon." When Liang Shi closed the room door, she also turned off the room light, saying gently: "This kind of weather is perfect for sleeping. I just woke up and was thinking about asking what you wanted to eat."

Xu Qingzhu hadn't asked what she did in the afternoon, yet she was volunteering information about her whereabouts.

It rather felt like trying to cover up.

Xu Qingzhu's footsteps suddenly paused, and she turned back to glance at her.

Liang Shi almost bumped into her back, forcibly stopping her steps. When she met her searching gaze, she looked away, "What's wrong?"

"Nothing." Xu Qingzhu said calmly: "Rainy days are indeed suitable for sleeping. I also slept for a while after coming back."

"Mm." Liang Shi asked: "What takeout did you order?"

She really couldn't muster any energy, despite trying very hard to pretend.

The pretense wasn't convincing.

The ending tone of every sentence was falling.

Lifeless and spiritless.

Xu Qingzhu said: "Hot pot."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Rainy days and hot pot are the perfect match." Xu Qingzhu said: "And it's spicy too. Oh right, you can eat spicy food, can't you?"

Liang Shi: "...I can."

The level of spiciness Liang Shi could accept was medium spicy, but it looked like what Xu Qingzhu had ordered was extra spicy.

A layer of Sichuan peppercorns and chili peppers floated on top, appearing blindingly red under the living room lights.

Xu Qingzhu sat down expressionlessly. All the side dishes were complete on the table; they just needed to turn on the heat and wait for the oil in the pot to boil.

Footnotes: ¹ Haizhou City: The fictional coastal city where the story takes place